
Philipp Hilbert. *Proxy Product Owner, Retail Banking Digital.*

Positioning, thirteen years owning backlogs and bridging business and engineering teams in regulated industries, now applying that discipline to Mashreq's retail banking digital agenda.

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§ WHY MASHREQ

Mashreq's Injaz programme sits at an interesting intersection: a large incumbent bank building digital products at squad velocity, in one of the most competitive retail banking markets in the world. The posting is explicit that the PPO role owns not just the backlog but also sprint execution, release readiness, and the translation layer between compliance, engineering, and business, which is exactly the scope I have operated at for the past seven years. The detail that this role sits inside a named Agile squad (Injaz) inside the Retail Banking Group tells me the organisation has moved past agile theatre and into structural delivery commitment. *That is exactly the environment where my strengths compound.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo spec generation and edge-case drafting
- **GitHub Copilot**, assisted implementation review
- **Cursor / VSCode**, code-level requirement validation
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototype iteration
- **Framer**, design-heavy workflow mockups
- **GPT**, structured document drafting and analysis

- **Jira + Confluence**, backlog and sprint artefacts
 - **Azure DevOps**, CI/CD pipeline and work-item tracking
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§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps rollout and rollback, Jenkins, Azure DevOps, CI/CD pipelines, Git, GitLab, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), Django, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Dagster, dbt, SQL, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT MASHREQ

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow the squad's current sprint ceremonies, read the existing backlog against the product roadmap, and identify where acceptance criteria are underspecified or where business and engineering hold conflicting assumptions about scope.

WEEK 2

Sharpen and slice.

Rewrite the top ten backlog items to production-quality user stories with testable acceptance criteria, then run a single refinement session with engineering and QA to validate feasibility before they enter sprint planning.

WEEK 3+

Ship and close loops.

Own committed sprint items end to end, from story sign-off through daily stand-up blockers to release gating, and introduce a lightweight definition-of-done checklist aligned to Mashreq's compliance and UAT requirements.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Digital Product Expert / Proxy Product Owner role within Mashreq's Retail Banking Group. With thirteen years of product ownership across regulated industries, insurance, public-sector analytics, defence AI, healthcare, and payments, I have spent most of my career doing exactly what this role describes: standing between business stakeholders and engineering squads, keeping both honest, and making sure committed backlog items actually ship.

The framing in your posting resonates with how I work. Requirements engineering, user stories, and acceptance criteria are not documentation overhead for me; they are the primary tool for reducing waste. At CLINET Platforms, I inherited a backlog a five-person team could never have delivered. I cut it to the top 10 per cent of features against agreed success measures, rewrote every remaining item to production-quality acceptance criteria, and watched user acceptance rise more than fivefold. At Rohde and Schwarz, I used the same discipline at the opposite scale, managing fifteen-plus engineers and data scientists through Scrum in Jira and Confluence on a multinational defence AI programme, and delivered a hotfix-capable GitOps pipeline that reduced rollout time from days to thirty minutes.

Your posting calls out Azure DevOps specifically, and I work in it alongside Jira depending on the organisation. The underlying discipline is identical: a backlog is only as useful as the quality of its items and the rigour of sprint planning and refinement. I bring the technical fluency to sit in an architecture discussion and the stakeholder-management practice to translate that conversation into something QA and compliance can act on.

Retail banking is a new vertical for me, and I say that plainly. What I bring is a proven pattern of landing in regulated, high-stakes delivery environments, Bundesdruckerei's secure data platform, Bundesagentur für Arbeit's national labour-market analytics, Scheidt and Bachmann's POS and payment systems, and getting to effective sprint execution within weeks rather than months. The compliance and governance instincts carry across.

I am open to relocation to Dubai and would welcome the chance to discuss how my background maps to the Injaz squad's current priorities.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product manager and proxy product owner with thirteen years of backlog ownership in regulated industries: defence AI, public-sector analytics, insurance, healthcare, and payments.

Consistent track record of translating ambiguous business requirements into prioritised, sprint-ready backlogs, leading cross-functional teams through Scrum delivery, and shipping in environments where compliance, engineering, and business stakeholders rarely agree on priorities until someone forces clarity.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

Agile and Sprint Delivery: Scrum, Kanban, SAFe, sprint planning, backlog refinement, user stories, acceptance criteria, definition of done, story-point estimation, velocity and burndown, retrospectives, Azure DevOps, Jira, Confluence.

Requirements Engineering: functional specifications, use cases, workflows, UAT (user acceptance testing), release gating, stakeholder alignment, cross-functional facilitation.

Product Management: continuous discovery, product roadmap, prioritisation, MVP definition, PoC, A/B testing, user research, prototyping, go-to-market support, product lifecycle management.

SDLC and Delivery Practices: GitOps, ArgoCD, CI/CD, Jenkins, containerised environments, Docker, Kubernetes, branching strategy, regression and end-to-end test automation, defect-to-fix and cycle time as product metrics.

Analytics and Data: KPI definition, funnel and churn analysis, ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt engineering, evaluation loops, human-in-the-loop design, AI governance, EU AI Act, Explainable AI; prototyping with Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable.

Governance: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership, ROI reasoning.

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI, FCAS 2024-2025

Cross-functional team of 15+ engineers and data scientists, Scrum in Jira and Confluence. Delivered GitOps rollout pipeline (ArgoCD) cutting deployment time from days to 30 minutes; redirected strategy based on workflow instrumentation, lifting pipeline runs 200%.

**BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC-SECTOR
ANALYTICS 2023-2024**

National labour-market analytics platform. Introduced Dagster and dbt, saving 75% of time per data update; migrated bare-metal to containers; UI relaunch; Deputy IT Security Officer.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE 2023

Inherited an undeliverable roadmap; cut to top 10% against agreed success measures, user acceptance up fivefold. Shipped CGM/KIS integration, reducing digital anamnesis from 30 minutes to 5.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURANCE B2B SAAS 2022

Restructured 18-person delivery org into three lean teams; attrition dropped from near-total exodus to one departure. Shipped Claims Center from concept to production; cut new-product launch cycle from months to under one week.

**SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION · RETAIL
PAYMENTS, POS 2021-2022**

Moved research into production across a matrix organisation in a fully SAgE setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

**BUNDESDRUCKEREI · PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM) · GOVERNMENT SECURE
DATA 2021**

Data structures and identity management for Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

**AOK ITSCARE · PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY) · HEALTH INSURANCE, E-
COMMERCE 2019-2020**

Migrated legacy system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and ~20,000 employees; still in production. Backlog refinement, user stories, and acceptance criteria in Jira.

ENERCON · PROJECT LEAD · WIND ENERGY, IT 2019

Full site IT modernisation end to end.

**WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE, CLINICAL
NETWORK 2017-2018**

Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PM · CONSTRUCTION STAFFING MARKETPLACE 2025-PRESENT

Zero-to-one two-sided B2B marketplace; anonymity-until-payment model; LLM agents across the funnel; SQL funnel and conversion analysis.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · IT SECURITY, QUANTUM ENCRYPTION 2016-2021

Shipped a three-layer quantum-secure encryption product that installs in under two minutes. Later Chair of the Board.

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES · CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO · AGRITECH 2018-2021

Laboratory to investor rounds; financial planning and investor reporting.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH, P2P PAYMENTS 2013-2018

Mobile group-based P2P payments built from zero, acquired and operated by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · www.true-north.berlin · [YouTube \(EN sample\)](#)

TRUE NORTH · APPLICATION PACKAGE · MASHREQ CORPORATE &
INVESTMENT BANKING GROUP

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